

Executive Summary

The humanitarian sector is scaling up anticipatory action (AA), enabling proactive mobilisation to get ahead of predictable climate-related shocks and disease outbreaks through robust forecasting (triggers), pre-agreed activities, and pre-arranged funding. This approach has proven effective, dignified, cost-efficient, and protective of development gains.

This document presents the framework for drought anticipatory action in Afghanistan. It entails coordinated packages of assistance planned to be delivered to people at risk of spring drought in Afghanistan across four prioritised spring rain and grain dependent provinces – Faryab, Sar-e-Pul, Takhar and Badakhshan. The framework was developed through a participatory process of humanitarian partners who formed an Anticipatory Action Group, coordinated by OCHA, under the overall leadership of the Deputy Special Representative of the Secretary-General/Resident Coordinator/Humanitarian Coordinator (DSRSG/RC/HC).

The financing

The Emergency Relief Coordinator has approved \$20 million combining pre-committed financing by the Central Emergency Response Fund (CERF) and the Afghanistan Humanitarian Fund (AHF) – the first time a single framework has been backed by both pooled funds. Payout of these funds will only occur if the pre-agreed trigger thresholds are reached. The funding will allow humanitarian partners to provide multi-purpose cash (\$4.2m) and in-kind and cash-based assistance across Agriculture and Livelihoods (\$2.6m), Food (\$1m), Health (\$4m), Nutrition (\$2m), Protection (\$1.3m), and WASH (\$5m) sectors. These figures are not yet final as the AHF funding envelopes are subject to Advisory Board approval.

The trigger

The financing and activities included in this framework will be triggered by either the following:

- *Forecast-based trigger (window A):* If the February European Centre for Medium-Range Weather Forecasts (ECMWF) predicts March-May rainfall below a 1-in-4.2-year threshold in at least one of three provinces.
- *Observation and forecast-based trigger (window B):* If the composite indicator monitored in April is above its 1-in-5.2-year return period threshold, in at least one of three provinces. (*details are in the trigger section below*)

The overall return period is 1-in-2.3, and the average number of years to allocate the full \$10m in CERF funding is 1-in-3.4 years. Historical activation details for the framework are shown in the table below¹.

Trigger Mechanism Statistics			
Stats by trigger		Analysis years: 1984-2024	
Trigger	Return period	Activation probability	Years activated
Window A	3.2 years	31%	1984, 1985, 1986, 1988, 1989, 2001, 2008, 2012, 2013, 2014, 2018, 2021, 2022
Window B	3.5 years	29%	1986, 1989, 2000, 2001, 2004, 2006, 2008, 2011, 2018, 2021, 2022, 2023
Overall stats			
Overall return period		2.3 years	Average period for total budget spend 3.4 years
Overall probability of activation		43%	Probability of total budget spend 29%
Average total spending per year with activation		\$6.9M	Average total spending per year \$2.9M

The action plan

The framework will enable humanitarian partners to implement anticipatory activities in a coordinated manner. Activities covered via CERF funding will be delivered both under **Window A (after the first trigger) (\$3.4m)** and **Window B (after the second trigger) (\$6.6m)** and focus on food security and livelihoods, WASH, and Protection, while the AHF allocation focuses in enabling response for **Window B (\$10m)** with an increased focus on Health and Nutrition, while also

¹ Budget-related figures only include the CERF budget.

The “overall return period” corresponds to years where at least one of the windows activates.

The “average period for total budget spend” is the average period for the whole CERF framework budget (\$10M) to be spent on framework activations

complementing WASH and protection components. To promote choice and dignity among beneficiaries, and in response to feedback gathered through Afghanistan’s Community Voices and Accountability Platform highlighting the affected populations’ strong preference for cash assistance, both CERF- and AHF-funded activities include various forms of cash assistance. CERF funding will be made available to UN agencies while the AHF funding will exclusively cover national and international NGO partners. All activities identified are critical and align with the lifesaving criteria of the 2025 HNRP reprioritisation (Strategic objective 1) as well as CERF/AHF’s lifesaving focus. All activities tied to each window will be implemented in all four selected provinces, if the trigger thresholds for one of the three monitored provinces (Faryab, Sar-e-Pul, and Takhar) is exceeded. Even if not monitored, Badakhshan will also be included in the response on a no-regrets basis but is not monitored.

The pre-agreed actions will focus on the following modalities:

- **Communicating risks, engaging with communities, and early warning messaging:** early warnings, community disease prevention and hygiene messaging.
- **Providing in-kind assistance:** including food, drought tolerant seeds, livestock protection inputs, emergency medical, dignity and hygiene supplies, therapeutic nutrition, and water infrastructure rehabilitation.
- **Provision of Select Types of Cash Assistance:** This includes Multi-Purpose Cash Assistance (MPCA), sector-specific cash, and integrated mixed-modality Cash+ packages, all aimed at strengthening household-level drought preparedness based on self-identified priorities.
- **Facilitating access to services:** through mobile health clinics, maternal and mental health services, nutrition screening, water quality measures, referrals for protection needs, and disease surveillance and prevention services.

The learning

Partners have agreed to conduct a coordinated post-distribution monitoring exercise in the case of a framework activation. FAO will undertake an impact evaluation primarily for livelihoods but with multi-sectoral observations on behalf of other participating partners. An after-action review will further be conducted to gather lessons learned from the development and potential implementation of the framework. Partners have also planned a broader / coordinated impact evaluation in 2026.

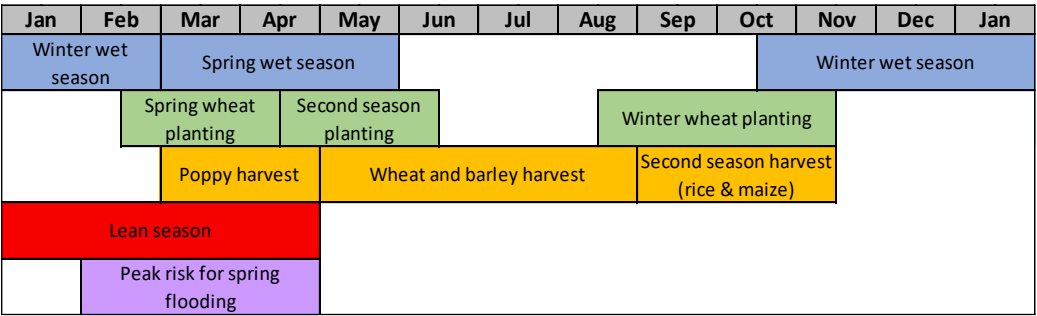
Validity period

The present framework is valid for an initial period of two years following endorsement of the ERC (2025-2026). The 2025 season will be a pilot phase given that it constitutes the first inter-agency anticipatory action experience in Afghanistan. For 2026, lessons learned from both the development and potential implementation of the framework will be applied to enhance and increase the scope of the current framework in collaboration with the AA Group.

1. Drought in Afghanistan

Afghanistan remains among the most climate-vulnerable countries globally, ranked sixth by the Notre Dame Global Adaptation Index and eighth by the INFORM Climate Change Risk Index. With a CERF Index for Risk and Vulnerability score of 74/100 (as of July 2024), it is in the top five most vulnerable countries worldwide. According to the World Bank², from 1951 to 2023, Afghanistan’s mean annual temperature rose by approximately 2.46°c and future temperature increases are predicted to exceed global averages, intensifying drought risks. By 2030, annual droughts may become normal in many areas. Between 2020 and 2025, Afghanistan experienced repeated droughts, severely impacting coping capacities and drastically reducing groundwater levels, in some cases by up to 30 meters. Despite predictions of favorable precipitation during the 2023-24 El Niño, the country faced a dry spell, with precipitation deficits of up to 55 per cent below average in eastern and northeastern regions, and moderate to mild deficits elsewhere. Rainfed winter wheat regions were particularly affected.

La Niña typically brings below-average precipitation and higher temperatures. Compounding these issues, Afghanistan’s water and sanitation infrastructure remains inadequate, further stressing vulnerable communities. Previous CERF drought allocations for Afghanistan have varied in size, with an average of \$13.4 million via the rapid response window and \$11.8m via the underfunded emergencies window. Funding requests were typically submitted in April-May or August-October periods.



² World Bank Climate Change Knowledge Portal – Afghanistan. Available online: <https://climateknowledgeportal.worldbank.org/country/afghanistan/climate-data-historical>

2. Coordination Arrangements

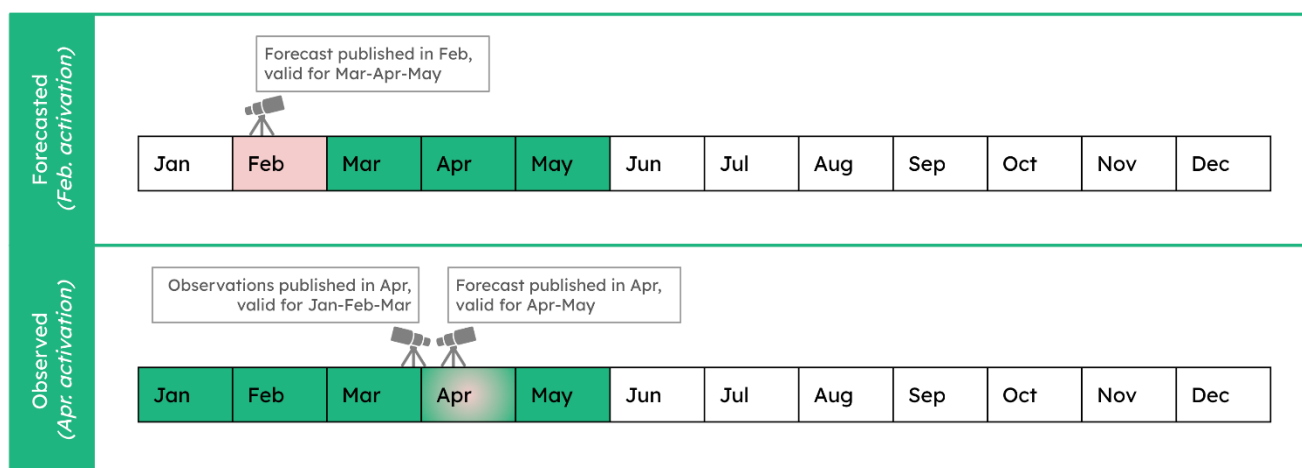
An AA Group, constituted following an invitation to interested partners through the HCT and comprising FAO, IOM, OCHA, UNFPA, UNICEF, UN Women, and WFP, has been leading the process. The Group also comprises and is supported by technical working groups of the Inter Cluster Coordination Team (ICCT) – Accountability to Affected Populations (AAP), Gender in Humanitarian Action (GiHA), Cash Working Group (CWG) – and sub-national coordination leads – Operational Coordination Teams (OCT) + Regional ICCGs in the Northern and North-Eastern regions. A dedicated Trigger Sub-Group was also stood up to refine trigger threshold and timing parameters. The AAP Working Group and UNFPA (on behalf of the AA Group) coordinate early warning messaging and community engagement, aligning sector- and partner-specific communication channels. UNICEF will leverage its extensive experience and geographical presence to focus on timely integration of WASH elements. The CWG advises on aligning cash-based interventions, standardising transfer values and reducing duplication while ensuring complementarity with ongoing CVA interventions. WFP with support by UNICEF and UN Women leads a collaborative MPCA approach through shared registration systems (where possible) and streamlined targeting criteria in addition to support on profiling target populations to identify Women Headed Households and Persons with Disabilities to ensure proportionate inclusion. FAO, on behalf of the AA Group, conducts ground truthing to verify drought triggers and monitors data while also leading a livelihoods-focused impact evaluation including multi-sector indicators. UN Women, leveraging its gender technical expertise and extensive evidence base on gender equality and women's empowerment in the context of Afghanistan, supports gender mainstreaming across the AA framework, including through the GiHA WG. Going forward, the AA Group shall be converted into an AA Community of Practice for Afghanistan open to all organisations engaged in AA in country and with rotating co-chairs.

Synergies with other initiatives

This framework aligns with the Afghanistan National Disaster Management Authority (ANDMA) 2025-2029 strategic plan for disaster management which identifies key hazards – including drought, the third most significant, which inflicts an estimated \$280 million in annual losses. This plan highlights preparedness measures, priorities, and resources, recognising OCHA and UN partners as strategic collaborators. In parallel, this AA framework coordinates with other anticipatory action initiatives currently under development such as those by the Afghan Red Crescent Society, IRC, Afghanistan and World Vision. Collaboration with the World Bank is underway to further harmonize drought monitoring, including the AA triggers. Joint AA orientations have already been conducted with OCHA, partners, IFRC, in addition to engaging and raising awareness with relevant authorities at national and sub-national level.

3. Triggers and Thresholds

The trigger mechanism is divided into two main monitoring windows: 1. Pre-Season, 2. Mid-Season. It uses a combination of environmental metrics, seasonal rainfall forecast, observed rainfall, snow cover and vegetative health metrics with the threshold set based on historical analysis and estimated return periods.



Triggers and thresholds

The financing and activities included in this framework will be activated by the triggers outlined in the table below.

Window	Indicator	Data Source	Evaluation time	Province-level return period threshold
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Window A (forecast-based)	Forecasted precipitation for Mar-Apr-May	ECMWF SEAS5 ³	Early February	4.2 years ⁴
Window B (observation- and forecast-based)	Composite drought indicator (composition outlined in table below)	Multiple	Early April	5.2 years ⁵

For each window, the trigger is activated if the current value of the indicator is more extreme than the level corresponding to the *province-level return period threshold*⁶, any of the three provinces (Faryab, Sar-e-Pul, Takhar)⁷, Badakhshan will also be included in the response on a no-regrets basis but is not monitored.

For window B, the *composite drought indicator* is composed of the individual indicators in the table below. The individual indicators are combined⁸ using weights that were selected to optimize the trigger's accuracy.

Indicator	Data Source	Value used	Weight
Agricultural Stress Index (ASI)	FAO ⁹	End of March (Dekad 3)	25%
Vegetation Health Index (VHI)	FAO ¹⁰	End of March (Dekad 3)	25%
Combined observed and forecasted precipitation	ECMWF (ERA5 ¹¹ and SEAS5)	Observation: March Forecast: April-May (issued April)	25%
Snow cover	ECMWF ERA5-LAND	March	15%
Accumulated seasonal precipitation	ECMWF ERA5	Total over Jan-Feb-Mar	5%
1-metre soil moisture	ECMWF ERA5	End of March	5%

The combined observed and forecasted precipitation indicator includes observed March precipitation (ERA5) and forecasted precipitation (SEAS5) for April and May published in April. All monthly values were normalized to z-score and then averaged together. The return period values for all indicators in both windows are based on the reference period of 1984-2024 (inclusive).

All raster indicators in both windows are aggregated as the mean over the province.

Trigger activation protocol

Pre-defining the activation protocol is critical in order to avoid delays, miscommunication, uncertainty or errors once the trigger threshold is reached. For the Afghanistan drought AA framework, OCHA's Centre for Humanitarian Data (CHD) will monitor the indicators for both windows (forecast and observational indicators). The monitored data/results (whether trigger thresholds are crossed or not crossed) will be validated with the 'Triggers Sub-Group', which is led by FAO. The trigger sub-group either confirms or disputes the finding of the CHD's analysis of monitored trigger thresholds (trigger threshold reached "yes/no") within 48 to 72 hours. This is done supported via a ground-truthing¹² exercise undertaken by the trigger sub-group. If the ground truthing disagrees with the forecast analysis by CHD, further discussion will take place at the AA

³ High-resolution SEAS5 data is shared with CHD directly by ECMWF. A slightly lower-resolution product is available publicly at <https://cds.climate.copernicus.eu/datasets/seasonal-monthly-single-levels>

⁴ A 4.2-year return period corresponds to 10 out of 41 historical years triggering in each province

⁵ A 5.2-year return period corresponds to 8 out of 41 historical years triggering in each province.

⁶ Note that the "province-level return period threshold" for each window is higher than the return period of each window outlined in the Executive Summary. This is because the window as a whole will, by definition, activate at least as frequently as any one of the provinces, since only a single province has to meet the threshold for the window to activate.

⁷ For example, if the current value of Window A is 100mm in a certain province, and the value that corresponds to a 4.2-year return period in that province is 120mm, we would trigger, since this value is more extreme than the return period value (these values are fabricated for the example).

⁸ Specifically, the indicators were combined by taking the Z-score of each indicator (reversed where relevant, so that a high value always corresponds to poor agricultural conditions), then combining them using a weighted average using the corresponding weights. The optimal weights were determined by iterating over all possible weight combinations at 5% intervals.

⁹ Data available publicly at: https://www.fao.org/giews/earthobservation/asis/data/country/AFG/MAP_ASI/DATA/ASI_Dekad_Season1_data.csv

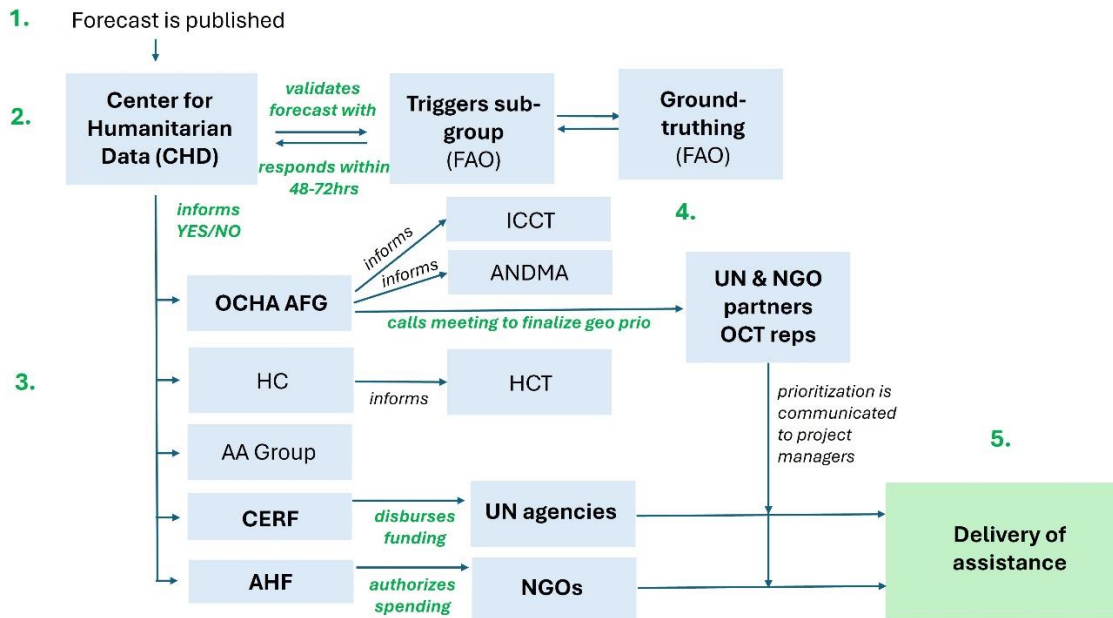
¹⁰ Data available publicly at: https://www.fao.org/giews/earthobservation/asis/data/country/AFG/MAP_NDVI_ANOMALY/DATA/vhi_adm1_dekad_data.csv

¹¹ Data available publicly at: <https://cds.climate.copernicus.eu/datasets/reanalysis-era5-land-monthly-means>

¹² Ground truthing will be conducted in some or all of the second-tier prioritised districts across Takhar, Badakhshan, Faryab, and Sar-e-Pul, based on trigger results. It will verify key drought indicators for both activation windows, combining observational data with community input to guide response decisions. If needed, structured and semi-structured questionnaires will be used to gather insights from farmers, herders, community leaders, water managers, and field officers. In case of time crunch and if several other outside sources confirm the trigger results, a lighter approach may be applied.

Group to evaluate the results in relation to humanitarian conditions and in case there's still disagreement, the final decision can be deferred to the RC/HC.

Once 'trigger threshold reached' is validated by FAO on behalf of the trigger sub-group, CHD informs the Humanitarian Coordinator, OCHA Afghanistan, the Afghanistan AA Group, CERF and the AHF via email. The HC will inform the HCT of the activation. OCHA Afghanistan will organise the finalisation of the final-tier geographic prioritisation (if not done already) with UN and NGO partners and inform the ICCT and ANDMA of the activation. Immediately following the CHD's notification of trigger thresholds reached, the CERF (based on ERC pre-approved projects) and AHF will send project approval letters to partners and disburse funding.



4. Geographical Prioritisation

The geographical prioritisation for the AA framework followed a three-tiered approach:

a) Provincial Prioritisation:

Considering historical trends, a significant number of provinces in Afghanistan – spanning an arch from the western to northern and northeastern regions – have been affected by droughts. The AA Group conducted an analysis to determine priority provinces, factoring in:

- Areas with high percentages of rain-fed agricultural land (compared to irrigated land), as rain-fed agriculture is more vulnerable to droughts.
- Average yearly rainfall anomalies (2020–2023) to identify provinces already impacted by prolonged multi-year drought conditions, assuming these areas are still recovering from past drought effects.
- Underlying vulnerability in the form of food insecurity, based on IPC data, particularly focusing on provinces with high percentages of IPC3+ caseloads.

Based on this analysis and consultations with regional Inter-Cluster Coordination Groups, four priority provinces emerged: Faryab and Sar-e-Pul (Northern Region) and Takhar and Badakhshan (Northeastern Region).

District Prioritisation:

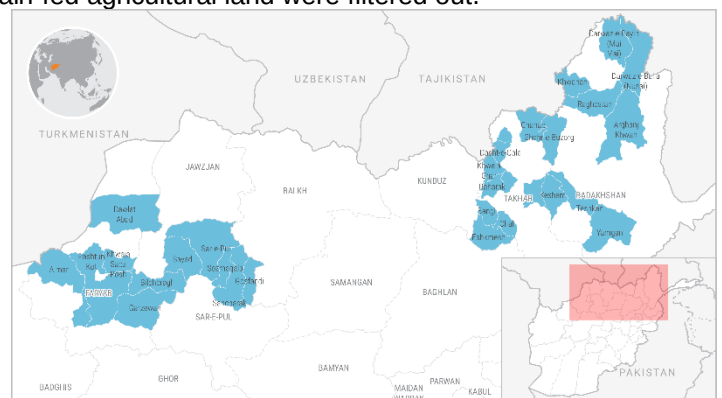
Given the large geographical coverage of these four provinces, a further district-level prioritisation was conducted. OCHA, using data provided by REACH and the Assessment and Analysis Working Group, developed a long list of prioritised districts based on indicators such as food insufficiency, hunger levels, livelihood coping mechanisms, water insufficiency, agriculture, and livestock. Additionally:

- Urban areas and districts with less than 30 per cent rain-fed agricultural land were filtered out.
- The initial long list was shared with regional OCHA offices for refinement and validation based on ground realities and discussions with partners.

The list of 31 prioritised districts includes:

- **Nine (9)** districts in Badakhshan
- **Eleven (11)** districts in Takhar
- **Five (5)** districts in Sar-e-Pul
- **Six (6)** districts in Faryab

b) Final triaging of districts in the event of trigger activation



In the event of trigger activation, monitoring data on current meteorological and hydrological conditions, along with the latest vulnerability data, presented as a combined index, will be used to identify the 10-20 most vulnerable districts where anticipatory actions will be implemented. Where adequate data is provided, the composite can take into account relevant vulnerability data, including food insecurity, nutrition, agriculture and livelihoods, health, and access to water, depending on the availability of updated and disaggregated datasets.

Household-level Targeting

AA Group partners agreed on coordinated, transparent vulnerability indicators for household-level targeting, along with clear geographic delineation, deduplication, and coordination measures. For the CERF-funded MPCA component, partners have geographically delineated as follows: WFP will cover Badakhshan province and, jointly with UN Women, Faryab and Sar-e-Pul. UNICEF will cover Takhar province. The MPCA targeting framework drew on WFP's targeting approach and existing population profiling as a common foundation. UN Women and UNICEF refined their respective targeting approaches to align with their programmatic priorities, ensuring that the most vulnerable households are effectively reached. The resulting cash targeting framework was then compared with FAO's cash+ packages to minimise potential overlaps at the household level based on livestock holding criteria. Deduplication across the framework's activities and modalities – including sectoral, multisectoral, and Cash+ packages – was carefully considered along the following dimensions: pre-defined inclusion and exclusion criteria, distinct intended cash utilisation, geographic delineation; and package provision timelines, resulting in mutually exclusive targeting of affected populations by different partners in distinct locations or in adjusted complimentary packages. Partners also established internal operational considerations for joint assessments, registration and distribution where possible including exploring signing of data sharing agreements (where feasible) and separately agreed on external collaboration with local authorities. As a next step, they will detail the community and engagement of communities and authorities as well as messaging processes.

Female Participation, Gender and Disability Inclusion

The GiHA WG will support ensuring that all activities under the AA Framework are gender-responsive, with women's participation mainstreamed as a key component of every intervention. This includes providing direct technical advice to partners involved in the framework to ensure the gender-responsiveness of their activities. UN Women, as the co-chair of the GiHA WG and an AA implementing partner, will also coordinate with others under the AA Framework to ensure women and girls have access to anticipatory action. For example, UN Women will work with UNICEF on water distribution locations and support women's organisations and groups in managing water distribution points. Moreover, women's groups and women-led organisations will be involved in both the implementation and monitoring of interventions throughout the AA Framework.

UN Women interventions will be carried out in collaboration with women-led organisations, reflecting UN Women's principle of providing assistance "by women, for women" in Afghanistan. Pre-activation orientation will be conducted with women-led organisations and women's groups to ensure they understand the objectives of anticipatory action and can share this knowledge within their communities, further strengthening women's awareness and mitigating the impact of droughts. This pre-activation will take place before the trigger start, over an estimated period of up to eight weeks.

Inclusive and Adapted MPCA: In accordance with CWG minimum expenditure basket (MEB) guidance, which recommends a 15 per cent inclusion quota for women-headed households and 15 per cent quota for households with at least one person with a disability, framework partners delivering MPCA will apply a 20 per cent top-up to the standard transfer value for these groups. This measure aims to ensure that the cash assistance provided contributes to overcoming barriers that may otherwise hinder their access and meaningful participation.

5. Planned Activities

Selection criteria

Anticipatory actions aim to protect those most at risk before a shock hits / peaks. Actions selected followed these criteria:

- **Anticipatory character:** Activities effectively prevent or reduce the humanitarian impact of drought.
- **Feasible within the window of opportunity:** activities can be delivered within the lead time – i.e. between the trigger and peak of drought impact.
- **Operational capacity:** Partners have the necessary institutional (thematic, logistic, administrative, financial, human resources) capacity to implement these activities at scale within the lead time.
- **No regrets approach:** In case of a false alarm, proposed actions benefit (and not negatively affect) people targeted.

Objectives

The pre-agreed activities aim to mitigate the main humanitarian impacts of drought. They focus on:

- Enabling communities to take informed decisions
- Safeguarding agricultural production and reducing yield losses
- Avoiding deteriorating food security until harvest
- Sustaining animals to protect household livelihoods and avoid deterioration of malnutrition
- Ensuring availability of safe water for human and animal consumption

- Reducing the risk of disease outbreaks
- Reducing morbidity and mortality through access to essential goods and services
- Mitigating drought-related protection risks and use of negative coping strategies

Activities

The pre-agreed activities are:

- **Communicating risks, engaging with communities, and early warning messaging:** This includes early warning messaging, community sensitisation on disease outbreaks and hygiene promotion through targeted communication materials, engagement sessions, and household visits. The AAP Working Group is supporting this drought AA framework and partners to coordinate and streamline community engagement around drought. First, it is aligning sector- and partner-specific messages so local communities receive consistent, accurate information. Second, it has mapped over 14 community engagement channels – ranging from house-to-house visits to district-level teams – to ensure coverage of diverse population groups (including women, girls, and persons with disabilities). Third, the group is deploying its own resources (e.g., communication materials, technical guidance) to bolster outreach in each targeted district. Finally, it has formed a dedicated AA Community Engagement Task Team to oversee this process, gather feedback, and refine messaging including on people's intended cash utilisation based on evolving needs and insights from the field.
- **Providing in-kind assistance:** A set of in-kind assistance activities such as the provision of food packages, emergency medical supplies (including cholera kits, severe acute malnutrition-SAM kits, reproductive health kits), nutrient-rich foods and therapeutic foods for malnutrition prevention and treatment, hygiene kits (soap, water purification tablets, menstrual hygiene products), safe water storage supplies, and rehabilitation of water infrastructure (water points, water harvesting structures, boreholes, pumps, wells, storage tanks).
- **Providing sectoral cash, multi-sectoral cash and integrated mixed modalities (cash+):** cash for food, cash for protection, cash for work (water conservation – rehabilitation), cash + livestock protection package, cash + drought-resistant seeds package and MPCA. Women headed households and households with at least one member with a disability who are assessed as eligible for MPCA will receive a 20 per cent top-up in addition to the standard transfer value. *Note: Framework partners affirmed their alignment to cluster guidelines for sectoral cash and CWG guidance for MPCA and its entailed complementarity considerations.*
- **Facilitating access to services:** The framework supports access to health services via deployment of mobile health clinics and teams for maternal, child, and general healthcare; maternal health and obstetric referrals; mental health and psychosocial support; screening and referral for severe/moderate malnutrition; water testing and treatment; case management and referral for protection services (including gender-based violence-GBV, child protection); safe spaces; and infection prevention and disease surveillance services.

CERF partners are ramping up preparedness activities, particularly for WASH. They are mobilising their own resources, coordinating with local authorities to conduct water supply and gap assessments, prioritising villages, and performing technical/hydrogeological evaluations for new water sites. Regular monitoring of water levels, quality, community access, pricing, and WASH-related diseases is in place. If drought conditions worsen sooner than expected, UNICEF is ready to deploy short-term water trucking from its own resources. It will also distribute hygiene kits from existing stocks to families planned for MPCA.

Implementation timeline

	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Jan
Rainy season	Winter		Spring								Winter		
Peak drought impact													
Trigger moments		A		B									
Window A implementation				delivery of assistance									
Window B implementation							delivery of assistance						

The tables below summarise CERF and AHF-funded activities. Detailed budgets and numbers of targeted people can be found in the CERF Projects, AHF Allocation Strategy, and related proposals. All activities identified are critical and align with the lifesaving criteria of the 2025 HNRP reprioritisation (Strategic objective 1) as well as CERF/AHF's lifesaving focus.

CERF Funded Activities

Sector	Partner	Funding Envelope ¹³	Activity	Planned reach	Window
Cross-cutting	UNFPA, All		Early Warning messaging		Window A + B
Food Security	WFP	\$2.7m	Cash for food & in-kind food assistance	59,000 people	Window A
Multi-Sector	WFP		MPCA including top-ups for women-headed households (WHH) and people with disabilities (PwD)	59,000 people	Window B
Agriculture and Livelihoods	FAO	\$2.6m	Cash + livestock protection (animal feed, deworming, vaccination, etc.) cash can be used for locally available hay to make up for lack of fresh grazing)	1,600HHs (A) 2,000HH (B)	Window A + B
	FAO		Cash + seeds	1700 HHs	Window A
	FAO		Cash for work (water conservation - rehabilitation)	1,617 HHs	Window A
	FAO		Rehabilitation of water conservation structures	11 structures	Window B
WASH	UNICEF	\$3.2m	Construction/rehabilitation of climate resilient water supply systems	29,000 people (A) 36,000 people (B)	Window A + B
	UNICEF		Provision of water treatment system (reverse osmosis) + hygiene awareness on safe drinking water, storage and use, water conservation and reuse		
Multi-Sector	UNICEF		MPCA including top-ups for WHH and PwD	2,600 HHs	Window B Window B
Protection	UNFPA	\$1m	Dignity kits (women of reproductive age) Menstrual hygiene management kits	3,625 2,400	Window B
	UNFPA		Clean delivery kits (pregnant women)	1,825	Window B
	UNFPA UNFPA		Mobile Health Teams (will deliver the kits) including med supplies	53,000	Window B
	UN Women	\$0.5m	Safe Spaces Protection referrals, mental health and psycho-social support (MHPSS)	780 HHs	Window B
	UN Women		MPCA including top-up for WHH Gender mainstreaming and technical support	940 HHs	Window B Window A + B
Multi-Sector	UN Women				

¹³ CERF Funding envelopes by agency include EW messages, ground truthing, and other related enabling and operating costs

AHF Funded Activities

Sector	Partner ¹⁴	Indicative Funding ¹⁵	Activity	Phase/Window
Health		\$4m	- Mobile health clinics - Pre-positioned medicines (e.g., for dehydration, respiratory infections, vector-borne diseases) - Maternal & child health services (incl. reproductive health kits) - MHPSS & community sensitization - Infection prevention & disease surveillance - Free referral for obstetrical complications	Window B
Nutrition		\$2m	- Mobile Health & Nutrition Teams for screening & treatment of acute malnutrition - Counseling & community awareness on maternal, infant and young child nutrition (MIYCN) - Monitoring of Breast Milk Substitutes & code adherence - Transportation support to Therapeutic Feeding Units	Window B
WASH		\$2.5m	- Emergency water supply (rehabilitation/installation of wells, boreholes, storage tanks) - Safe water storage & household-level water treatment - Water conservation (rainwater harvesting, groundwater recharge) - Distribution of hygiene kits (soap, purification tablets, menstrual products) - Sanitation & hygiene promotion	Window B
Protection		\$0.5m	- Case management (GBV, child protection, general protection) - Cash for protection for high-risk individuals - Distribution of dignity kits - Civil documentation for women returnees & female-headed households - Referral to essential services	Window B
Multi-Sector /MPCA		\$1m	- Single tranche MPCA cash distribution aligned with CWG Minimum Expenditure Basket including top-ups for WHH and PwD	Window B

6. Pre-agreed Financing

Central Emergency Response Fund (CERF)

For this anticipatory action framework in Afghanistan, the ERC has pre-agreed to allocate *up to* \$10 million from the Central Emergency Response Fund (CERF) if triggers are reached.

CERF will disburse funds per window once three conditions are met:

- Endorsement by the Humanitarian Coordinator of the framework and the CERF application package, including agency project proposals and budgets and
- Endorsement by the Emergency Relief Coordinator of the finalised framework, as well as the CERF agency project proposals and budgets; and
- Activation of the pre-agreed triggers once the framework is fully approved and operational until end 2026.

CERF will disburse funds on a no-regrets basis as soon as the respective trigger is reached. Upon activation of any trigger, CERF will send out approval letters to the relevant agencies and subsequently will disburse all the funds for the respective window¹⁶. There are separate CERF projects and budgets by window (A and B). Even if Window A does not trigger, funds cannot be transferred from Window A to Window B, or vice versa. If either window does not trigger (or neither), funds remain pre-arranged for the following year (up until the end of the 2-year validity period of the framework).

Funding scenarios:

	Activation	Planned activities	Budget
Scenario 1	Triggers reached in February and April	Agriculture, Food, MPCA, Health, Nutrition, Protection, WASH + Early Warning	\$10m CERF + \$10m AHF
Scenario 2	Trigger reached only in February	Agriculture, Food, WASH + Early Warning	Window A CERF (\$3.4m)
Scenario 3	Trigger reached only in April	Agriculture, Food, MPCA, Health, Nutrition, Protection, WASH + Early Warning	Window B CERF (\$6.6m) + \$10m AHF

¹⁴ AHF partner selection will be finally confirmed after the Advisory Board's review and approval of the AA Allocation Strategy and review committee's evaluations of project proposals; the framework document will be updated accordingly.

¹⁵ AHF funding envelopes are indicative and will also only be final after the above.

¹⁶ While approval letters will be sent out immediately following an activation, the administrative transfer of funds to agencies may be delayed by a few days. To avoid a delay in project implementation, agencies confirm their ability to frontload the resources required to initiate their response until the funding has been received.

Further details can be found in the CERF project documents and CERF communications. Any changes to the projects and budgets have to be approved by the CERF Secretariat as per usual practice.

Having an anticipatory action framework supported by CERF neither precludes (nor guarantees) additional CERF Rapid Response funding to a country for the same or other shocks.

Afghanistan Humanitarian Fund (AHF)

The AHF is pioneering an anticipatory approach for drought, complementing CERF's focus across both Windows A and B by concentrating on activities that would be triggered under Window B and prioritising Health and Nutrition, with additional WASH and protection support, including MPCA. The allocation aims for equal distribution between national and international NGOs, pending partner suitability, and advances localisation. Funding is triggered only when pre-agreed thresholds are exceeded; if not triggered, project proposals remain in the grant management system for potential funding in the following year.

To identify suitable partners, 32 Expressions of Interest (EoIs) (16 from national NGOs and 11 from INGOs) were reviewed based on compliance status, alignment with cluster outcomes, geographic focus, drought anticipatory action relevance, operational capacity, and a 6-month project timeline (targeting June-August for assistance). Additional preference was given to Health and Nutrition projects, WASH with proven rapid implementation capacity, and integrated protection. Following the planned Advisory Board's review of the proposed AA Allocation Strategy, a 'review committee' will approve final proposals and funding disbursement only if the April trigger is activated. Indicative cluster funding envelopes are **Health (\$4M)**, **Nutrition (\$2M)**, **WASH (\$2.5M)**, **Protection (\$0.5M)**, and **MPCA (\$1M)**, subject to technical review and complementarity with CERF allocations.

All priority activities supported by the AHF under this framework align with the Afghanistan 2025 Humanitarian Needs and Response Plan. Using clear vulnerability criteria, partners ensure targeted support to the most vulnerable women, men, girls, and boys through a gender- and disability-inclusive approach. The AHF continues advancing cross-cutting areas to enhance the quality of projects it funds e.g., through mainstreaming Protection, Gender-based Violence (GBV), Gender & Age markers, Prevention of Sexual Exploitation and Abuse (PSEA), Accountability to Affected People (AAP), Disability Inclusion, and Cash-Based interventions, and enhanced humanitarian access throughout project design and implementation.

Learning, Monitoring and evaluation

This framework offers significant opportunities to both generate and apply learning, thus contributing to the overall improvement of humanitarian action in response to slow-onset shocks.

Each agency will use its existing monitoring & evaluation systems to collect and track data on implementation progress and outputs achieved. All findings will be shared. In addition, partners have agreed to conduct a joint Post Distribution Monitoring (PDM) in case of a framework activation. All UN agencies receiving CERF funding agreed to share data on targeted people, within existing regulations, and commit to providing relevant inputs to support the PDM. The final PDM report along with data will be made available to all framework partners. The PDM will be done in close coordination and communication with participating agencies. Furthermore, FAO will undertake an impact evaluation primarily for livelihoods but with multi-sectoral observations on behalf of other participating partners. The findings will be shared with all stakeholders involved.

An after-action review will further be conducted to gather lessons learned from the development and potential implementation of the framework. Partners have also planned a broader / coordinated impact evaluation in 2026. This will either follow the planned impact evaluation by FAO on behalf of AA implementing partners in 2025 or discussions could take place for an independent evaluation in 2026.

7. Validity and future of the framework

The present framework is valid for an initial period of about two years following endorsement of the ERC (2025-2026). The 2025 season will be a pilot phase given that it constitutes the first inter-agency anticipatory action experience in Afghanistan. In the subsequent 2026 season, lessons learned from both the development and potential implementation of the framework will be applied to enhance and increase the scope of the current framework in collaboration with the anticipatory action group.

8. Annexes

Core principles

Each anticipatory action framework is tailored to the local context. OCHA has identified nine core principles that should apply to the framework in Afghanistan:

- **Prioritizing a multi-sectoral approach:** Partners should prioritise multi-sectoral, co-targeted interventions, when possible, to maximise synergies and to achieve great impact.
- **Ensuring the centrality of protection:** In line with the IASC centrality of protection policy, and the principle of “leaving no one behind” (2030 Agenda), all partners implementing anticipatory interventions have the responsibility to ensure that their response will not aggravate the exposure of communities to risks of violence, insecurity, extortion and exploitation. Anticipatory actions must also ensure that they benefit all communities (local communities, displaced communities, returnees, and refugees) based on their needs, with due attention given to obstacles linked to gender, age, disability or social affiliation.
- **Ensuring gender equality is central to inclusive and accountable anticipatory action:** In line with IASC Policy on Gender Equality and the Empowerment of Women and Girls in Humanitarian Action, all partners are responsible and accountable to ensure humanitarian action, including anticipatory action is: rights-based; recognises gender-based and intersectional needs, as well as potential gender-based discrimination in access to resources and services; facilitate leadership and contribution of crisis-affected women and girls in the planning, implementation, monitoring and evaluation of anticipatory actions and early response, that directly impact their lives and those of their dependents and wider communities.
- **Promoting accountability to affected populations and the Protection from Sexual Exploitation and Abuse (PSEA):** Partners engaged in the implementation of the anticipatory action framework are responsible for the integration of accountability to affected populations approaches in their activities. This includes making all efforts to solicit, hear, and act upon the voices and priorities of affected people (including the most marginalised and at-risk women, men, girls and boys) in a coordinated manner, before, during, and after anticipatory action. It also means ensuring that community feedback leads to corrective action in future anticipatory action.
- **Supporting localisation:** All partners involved in the implementation of this framework are expected to honor the HCT’s commitment towards localisation. Equitable partnerships with local actors building upon their long-term relationships and trust with communities during anticipatory action are crucial.
- **Engaging in partnerships:** Collaboration across humanitarian actors is key to ensuring that all sectors are engaged, and that assistance is mobilised according to the AA framework.
- **Generating development and climate adaptation co-benefits:** Pilot participants are encouraged to consider how financing for anticipatory action can complement financing for development by reducing suffering and addressing the root causes of problems while supporting adaptation to climate change.
- **Capturing learning:** Monitoring, evaluation and learning activities should be embedded at every phase of the development and implementation of the AA framework.
- **Striving for integration:** The framework seeks to integrate the anticipatory action activities into the existing humanitarian architecture and to foster linkages with long term programming, including resilience and development initiatives.

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